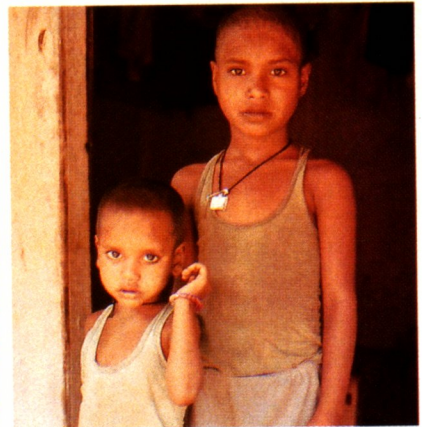


HELPING HAND

Care Today reaches out to five families devastated in the 2005 Kashmir earthquake and helps them rebuild their lives with financial assistance



FAMILIES WHO RECEIVED AID FROM CARE TODAY: (Clockwise from top left) Manika Begum with her children, Bablu Murmu with his family, Zarina Bibi's daughters, Kuraisha Bibi and Sanjida Bibi

CARE TODAY had stumbled upon the Jharkhandi widows by chance. Our relief work in Uri (Baramulla district) with the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) in the immediate aftermath of the October 2005 Kashmir earthquake had been focussed on local families who had been directly affected. It was the BRO officials who told us of the five road labourers from Jharkhand who had died, and of the one whose leg had to be amputated, and of their families who had lost their breadwinners and were not receiving any aid. A CARE TODAY representative located each family in the far corners of Godda district and verified details provided by BRO. We saw for ourselves the difficulties the widows were facing to survive, and the problems the young amputee had to deal with to rebuild his life. We also saw the red tape in the way of them

receiving their official compensation, the demands for bribes and the middlemen who were trying to cash in on their immediate need to feed and clothe their children.

The first thing we did was to provide each widow with Rs 10,000 to meet immediate needs. We then fixed a quarterly grant for each of them depending upon their families' survival needs. Zarina Bibi, wife of late Mohammad Bashir Ansari and the mother of two young daughters, received Rs 2,400 every quarter. Kuraisha Bibi, wife of late Mohammad Halim Ansari and mother of a young son, received Rs 1,500. Sanjida Bibi, wife of late Razak Ansari and mother of three children, received Rs 3,600. Manika Begum, wife of late Kayamuddin Ansari and mother of six children, received Rs 6,000. Najma Bibi, wife of late Akbar Ansari, had just been

married and did not receive a quarterly grant. Bablu Murmu, the young amputee who was not liable for any compensation, received an initial grant of Rs 25,000 from CARE TODAY to meet medical expenses and a quarterly grant of Rs 6,000.

CARE TODAY went back after a year to meet the families. They have received their official compensation in full. We are sanctioning a small further grant to Manika Begum because of her large family and difficult relations with her in-laws. Bablu Murmu will be setting up a shop in his village, and is in the process of receiving some financial support from the government for this. We thank our donors who made this critical support to these families possible. We have received Rs 62,08,773 in the Comfort Kashmir Fund, and spent Rs 47,42,225 so far. We have spent Rs 2,03,000 on the Jharkhandi victims.